

How To Be A Good Deployment Strategist

Teamwork

"The strength of the team is each individual member. The strength of each member is the team."

— Phil Jackson

We need each other.



Gayathri Nair Nov 4th, 2025 at 10:21 AM

Hi team,
I'll be OOO next week (Nov 10-14) and need coverage for two projects:

1. OneRail - this one is in UAT, will need to cover 2 thirty min syncs
2. Individual Restaurant Group - currently live but will be launching additional sites (high maintenance client lol)

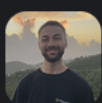
If anyone has bandwidth lmk 🙏 thanks!

8 replies



Tori Centeno Nov 4th, 2025 at 1:09 PM

Hi I can cover on IRG for some of the week, sorry for not replying before
Will message

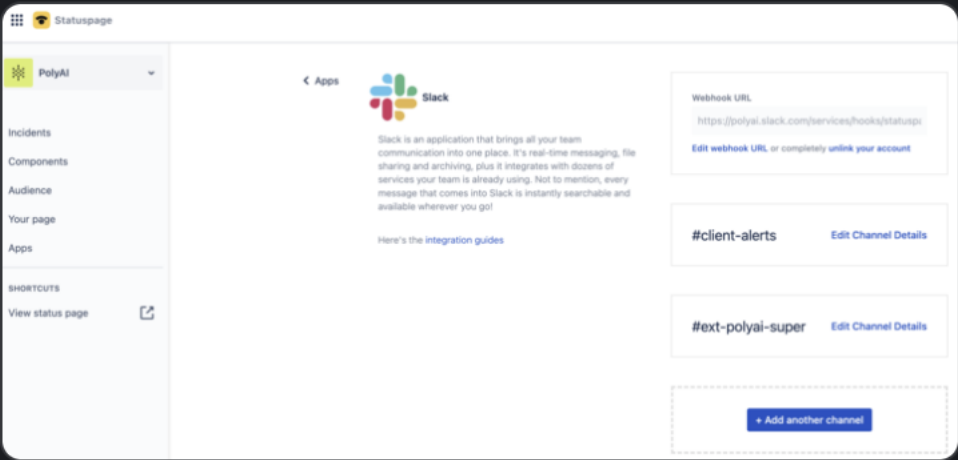


Reid Madison 1:32 PM

In case anyone else uses external slack channels w accounts... you can setup a statuspage integration with the slack channel through here:

<https://manage.statuspage.io/pages/1ystvhzwbh52/slackStatus>

Screenshot 2026-01-13 at 1.31.27 PM.png ▼

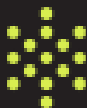


Katherine Conyer 5:06 PM

HELLO! I added my UAT template to the Deployments Team > UAT folder if you are so inclined. Link to template [here](#) + a quick(ish) [walkthrough](#). Hope some find it useful, feel free to send questions my way 🙌

3 ❤️ 3 🙌 1 😊

1 reply 3 months ago

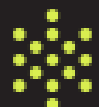


You Are The Driver

You are **NOT** a messenger of the client.

You lead with expertise and are a deployment master.

You guide, push, persuade, and control narratives.



Internal Communications

- Handover notes need to be in the public PSM channel — no backchanneling
- VOLUNTEER AND SUPPORT YOUR PSMs WHEN THEY'RE OUT — THIS IS NOTICED
- Force yourself to be in uncomfortable situations – this is how you grow



Internal Communications

- Hype your team.
- Have their back.
- Be there for them.
- Own Morale.
- Post Go Lives in General.



Reid Madison

8:30 AM

Huge shoutout to [@Zainab](#) for absolutely KILLING IT last week and getting us in an incredible position for Super.com UAT. Despite the team being understaffed, she stepped up as a true team player and put her top tier agent design skills on spotlight!

Zainab completely rebuilt the flows to be more low - code and client friendly, and consistently went above and beyond to reinforce the client's trust in us.

UAT kicks off today, and we're in a fantastic spot as we push to win this bakeoff and beat Decagon! 🚀👏



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6 replies

Last reply 15 days ago



Talía Sperry

8:42 PM

I wanted to shout out [@Luka](#) and [@Sophie](#) for all of the consistent hard work to get demo up and ready for Mattel today! We were able to provide detailed recording today for their highest volume use case (two weeks priors to the agreed upon timeline in the contract) and have received really positive feedback overall of how amazing the voice is!

GIF ▾



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Anushree Godbole

10:22 AM

I want to give a big shoutout to the whole PDS project team for our expansion to 120+ offices that rolled out yesterday and our move in front of the PDS contact center! This is just the start 🙌

[@Isobel Blythe](#) [@djordje.popovic](#) for being the foundation and rocks of this project from the very beginning - they have put in so much work building out the eventual 1000+ variants we will have up in running over the next month (i think the most we will have for any client?) and dealing with all of the change requests coming from PDS on behaviors and site data. What i was thinking could be a nightmare QA process turned out to be really smooth and seamless because of their organized efforts internally prepping and testing for each round of sites we're rolling out 🌟

[@Hannah](#) for sticking through a 3.5 hour 🤪 go live call with me late last night and being so on top of catching and fixing some surprise hiccups without causing alarm on the client side to make this a successful deployment 🌟

[@sophie.john](#) [@Nicole Raynor](#) for all of your support and help in pushing proper prioritization and change management expectations with the PDS contact center and business teams to drive better operations from their end 🌟

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4 replies

Last reply 3 months ago

Art of the Email

Emails are not simply recaps

They are to RE-ASSERT YOUR NARRATIVE

while providing crucial client updates.



Katherine Conyer <katherine.conyer@poly-ai.com>

to Louis, me ▾

Wed, Aug 27, 2025, 5:12 PM ☆ ↶ ⋮

Hi Terri!

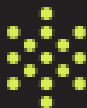
Before I wrap up today, wanted to send over a quick summary:

- **3 customer calls came through** (right on track with the 5% throttle).
 - **1** was a question about veteran food programs—I suspect not something for this line, so not a true gap on our side (though I'll wait to confirm this with you).
 - **2** were *excellent* 🥰 understanding was spot-on, back-and-forth felt natural (no long pauses), and answers landed perfectly. The only “downside” was not being able to help the customers self-serve in the VA—which I’ll happily count as a good sign for future use cases!
- The “next round of updates” items are in progress—we’ll have resolutions on all of those in the coming days. All changes are being tracked on our shared Google Sheet (and we’ll walk through that together tomorrow)

Quick reminder that you can listen to today’s calls at any time in Agent Studio (happy to do a quick refresher tomorrow if useful), and we’ll send a full day-1 export in the morning.

Thanks again for everything you’ve done to set us up for such a strong start. Excited to dig into more calls with you tomorrow!

Onward!
Katherine



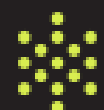
Dissecting Emails

A Bad Email:

- Regurgitates well known facts
- Asserts nothing
- Has incorrect formatting or is unhuman (don't use LLMs to write you an email, it is obvious)

A Good Email(er):

- Controls Narrative (See last email with bad/neutral call– “... so not a true gap on our side”)
- Is human (emojis/human language)
- Knows time and place for formality



Dissecting Emails



Katherine Conyer <katherine.conyer@poly-ai.com>
to Louis, me ▾

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Onward!
Katherine

VS.



Rob Baron <irobertbaron@gmail.com>
to me ▾

11:08 PM (0 minutes ago) ☆ 😊 ↩ ⋮

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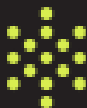
3 customer calls came through today.

1 call was about veteran food programs so we weren't able to handle it. 2 calls went really well. The back-and-forth felt natural.

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Thanks,
Katherine



Dissecting Emails

J

James Ramirez | Staff Contractor

Mon, Jan 26, 3:15 PM (1 day ago) ☆ ↶ ⋮

to Raymond, me, Alice, Brad, James, Talia, Stephanie, Aleksandra, Charles, Kayla, Nancy, Pavan, Brian, Drew, Carrie, Stacie, Tamara, James, Barry, Tabitha ▼

Team thanks for joining the call today –

Meeting notes:

- Par-a-dice Project Status and UAT Preparation: James Ramirez, Talia, Drew, Stacie, and others discussed the current status of the Paradise project, including the readiness of FAQ content, the need for a live number for fallback routing, the upcoming code freeze, and plans to begin UAT this week with Stacie and team conducting test calls.
 - FAQ Content Readiness: Talia confirmed that the FAQ content for Par-a-dice is ready to be sent to Poly AI, with the only outstanding item being the live number required for fallback routing; the team currently has a test extension (555) but needs the actual live number to connect to the DID.
 - Live Number Configuration: Drew provided details on the current configuration, explaining that the 555 extension is used for testing and will be replaced by the main number, while the temporary DID (3096983096) will be phased out once the main number is in place; Talia confirmed understanding and readiness to proceed.
 - UAT Scheduling and Code Freeze: Talia noted that UAT for Paradise can begin this week, with a code freeze scheduled for the following week (February 2nd–6th), and the team remains on track for a go-live date of February 10th, contingent on completing UAT as planned.
 - Test Call Assignments: James Ramirez asked Stacie and team (including Carrie) about their availability for conducting test calls during UAT; Stacie confirmed she has bandwidth to participate, and James committed to sending out the UAT sheet and coordinating the testing process.
- One-Way Audio Issue and Ticket Resolution: Drew, James Vowell, James Ramirez, and others reviewed the ongoing troubleshooting of a one-way audio issue, with Mustafa having identified the problematic interface and needing further time and architectural input to resolve the issue without causing downstream problems.
 - Issue Identification: Drew reported that Mustafa has pinpointed the source of the one-way audio problem to a specific interface, but the issue is complex due to legacy configurations and requires careful handling to avoid introducing new problems.
 - Resolution Timeline: When pressed for a timeline, Drew explained that Mustafa could not provide an estimate due to the complexity, and further consultation with network architects is necessary before a fix can be implemented and tested.
 - Testing and Follow-Up: Drew stated that once the network team addresses the issue, Mustafa will contact Drew and Pisa to conduct testing and confirm resolution; James Vowell and James Ramirez agreed to keep the team updated as progress is made.
- Evangeline Downs FAQ and Firewall Rule Coordination: James Ramirez, James Matte, and James Vowell discussed the status of the Evangeline Downs FAQ spreadsheet, outreach to department heads for content, and the need for firewall rule requests to be submitted promptly to support the project timeline.
 - FAQ Content Collection: James Matte reported sending mailers to food and beverage and other department heads at Evangeline Downs to gather input on how FAQ answers should be presented, but had not yet received responses from all department heads.

Brad Flickinger

12:33 PM (11 hours ago) ☆ ↶ ⋮

to Jacob, Ryan, Archawin, Chris, Ian, Chris, Lori, Kim, Bill, Mick, Maurice, me, Charles, Jim, Jorie, Brien, John ▼

Hi Team,

The critical Salesforce case creation issues are now resolved. Some issues do still linger but not show-stopping for launch. They are on agent-involved calls and the agents can help smooth some of that over. We had a call with Poly and their VP of engineering this morning and they've identified a potential fix for the past telephony issues. We will make a modification to our headers that flag to Poly to treat our calls differently (that stops the issues we've seen), as there is a known issue between Cisco and Poly.

Launch is set for tomorrow, Wednesday 1/28, at 2:00PM CST. This will allow the last-minute configurations to go in and any remaining testing that needs to be done.

It is extremely important we hit this deadline to launch tomorrow; end of month is here.

Technical / Project Updates

Salesforce Case Creation Status

- Critical scenarios (no human agent involved) for roadside case creation are working.
 - These include scenarios where the bot handles shop contact or dispatch.
 - Each scenario has been tested at least once this morning.
- Team plans to continue “hammer testing” until go-live.

Agent-assisted case scenarios:

- Case creation issues persist when agents are involved — timing issues or failures in creating/returning a case number.
- Mick is 95% sure they found the root cause.
- Willie confirms the fix appears simple and will be implemented soon.
- These issues aren't showstoppers because an agent is already in the loop.

Hi everyone,

Just wanted to send a quick **recap** from today's call.

We've already rolled out fixes based on feedback up to January 23rd, and we're now testing additional changes from the latest feedback through Wednesday. I'll let you know once those updates go live.

We're also moving forward with setting up SMS through Twilio.

Travis sent out an email earlier with more details on the Spanish VA, so be sure to check that out.

I know there are some concerns about latency and the voice quality sounding different from the original demo. We're actively working on improving latency, and if needed, we can explore other voice options to get closer to what you originally heard. I'll follow up with more details soon.

Let me know if you have any questions.

Kind regards,

Organization

The documentation for a given project post-sales lies with YOU

Organized UAT sheets

Strong Acceptance Criteria Documentation

Weekly Slides

Begin Weekly Calls with Timeline/Action Tracker/Slides

HCA + PolyAI Weekly Status - 10/1

Overall Status		Upcoming Milestones	Owner	Dates	Status
G	Design & Build: Build close to wrapped up, sending additional sample calls, and starting to prep for UAT. Internal implementation review Thursday 9/25	First Sample Calls	PolyAI	September 17	G
		UAT (Test Accounts/Not Full Integration for Telephony/Payments)	PolyAI to Build	October 6	G
		Initial Go Live (Real Integrations)	PolyAI/HCA Joint	October 27	Y
Weekly Progress		Action Items/ Blockers			
- UAT NEXT WEEK! - May move to Wednesday to give us time to ingest the Test Data and prep - PolyAI doing final UAT preparing and taking in feedback from HCA team - Product update on babysitter - Rob PTO next week - Pavan to cover (pavan.kaur@poly-ai.com>) - Rob to get HCA team access to agent studio and dashboards today/tomorrow		- Need to get unblocked on API access from ACI - this is our biggest blocker at the moment - Test Data - Telephony - Lumen contract update?			

Love's - Go-Live Call Reviews										
File Edit View Insert Format Data Tools Gemini Extensions Help										
Q Menus 100% 123 Inter 14 + B I A										
B1:R2 LOVE'S - Go-Live Call Reviews - Release Notes										
1	A	LOVE'S - Go-Live Call Reviews - Release Notes								
2		Conversation Review page								
3		INITIAL REVIEWS								
4	REF	DATE	USE CASE	CALL SID	DYNAMIC CALL LINK	RESULT	LOVE'S NOTES	POLYAI COMMENTS	POLY REVIEWER	RECOMM
5	1				View Conversation					
6	2				View Conversation					
7	3				View Conversation					
8	4				View Conversation					
9	5				View Conversation					
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+ Go-Live Prod Validation 1. Call Reviews & Call-Specific Release Notes 2. Generic Release Notes 4. General Questions 5. Feedback from Agents 6. Call Review										



Set Others Up For Success

- Do not invoke others in calls if you feel you are setting them up for failure
- The team needs to be allies to the client, not blockers
- Tee up talking points for your internal members
- Client calls are a dance especially when there's tension
- Talk HIGHLY about your colleagues. Don't just say they're a member of the team, say they are the lead, or the head, etc.



Control Narrative

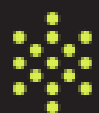
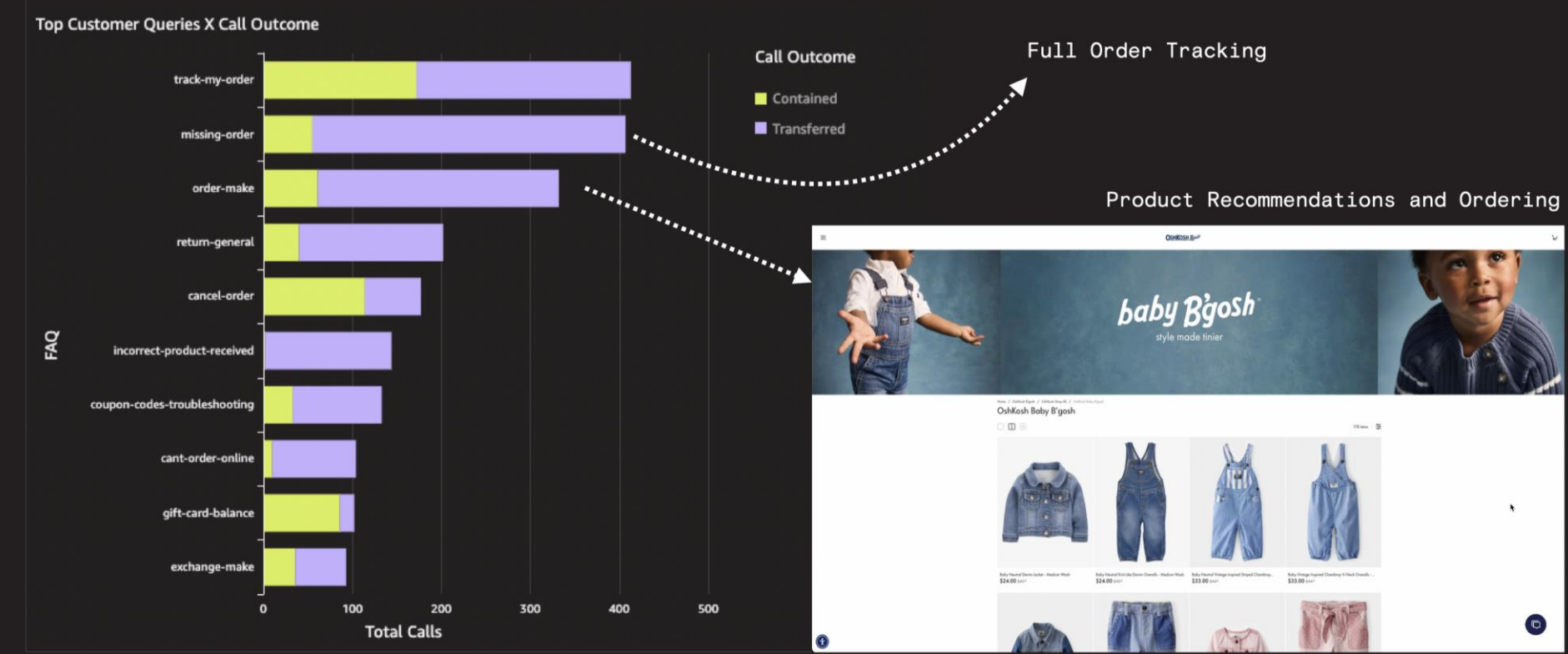
You're a storyteller.

- Tell stories with data - Talk about achievements/past client triumph
- Push for more and have faith in the internal team
- Whip up quick slide decks when necessary IE: Post hypercare with a client that’s still not 100% bought in. After a competitive POC or bakeoff.

What We’ve Achieved



Next Opportunities



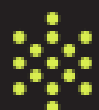
Learn to Live in Ambiguity

YOU are the person to get the project out of the mud.

PSMs fill in GAPS

ESCALATE

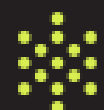
Lean on AEs/CSAMs for Commercial/Account Level Concerns



Listening to Calls

DO THE WORK

- Force ADs to schedule QAs
- Do metrics QAs
- UNDERSTAND YOUR METRICS
- Proactively log issues that you feel the client would be upset over – learn how to prioritize



Dashboarding

If you don't know the data well, your efficacy as a "strategist" is greatly depleted.

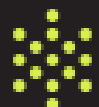
Look at other client datasets and dashboards.

Obsess over quality and make it fun for the client.



Data Hygiene

- Dashboarding and otherwise
- Don't mix clients up — whether it be an email or an Excel
- You want them to think they are important while also holding boundaries
- Know when to invoke the support team and when to do things yourself



Use Agent Studio

If you don't know how to make a KB change, use real time config, or update pronunciations in Audio Management...

You should.

Pay attention to product all hands. Watch enablement sessions.

SELF START



Know How to Use AI to Make Life Easier

- Formatting Data/Various Data tasks
- QS queries – It's very easy to use Claude for QS if you're unsure
- Notetaking (Granola/Gong) – there is no excuse for “forgetting” → track everything

There's so much at your disposal.

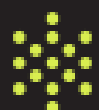


Learn Their Business & Know Your Stuff

It is on you and the AD to learn their business together.

You need to know the important metrics, the run rate utilization, the go live dates (roughly), etc.

You are THEIR AI SME.



Quick Tips

- If something doesn't sit right with you, do something about it. IE: Regenerate audio yourself
- Do not use the word outage to describe API errors – do not call into question PolyAI's uptime/etc.
- You don't always have to think quickly on your feet. Confidently saying “I don't know” is okay
- DON'T PASTE API CREDENTIALS INTO SLACK
- Understand CSAMs are there to support for build but you should not lean on them. We can introduce them but do not characterize them as people to assist during the build phase

